認知症の 方との 会話

Dementia Communication — Calm, Simple, Patient Responses — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Answer a resident with dementia who wants to go home or asks the same question again: accept what she says instead of correcting it, keep your sentences short, redirect gently, and stay beside her until she settles.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Tanaka-san (resident)

ねえ、そろそろ うちに 帰りますね。娘が 待って いるのよ。

Listen, I'll be going home soon. My daughter is waiting for me.

Why: 帰宅願望 — wanting to go home — is one of the most common things you will hear on an afternoon shift. She is not lying and she is not testing you: for her, right now, this is true. 〜のよ is 女性語, an older woman explaining something to you.

Hana (caregiver)

そうですか。娘さんが 待って いらっしゃるんですね。

I see. Your daughter is waiting for you, is she.

Why: The whole lesson is in this line: repeat her words back instead of correcting them. いらっしゃる is 尊敬語 for いる — you are speaking respectfully about her family. 〜んですね says 'I have understood you', which is what she actually needs. Correcting her only starts an argument you cannot win, and she will keep the fear long after she has forgotten your sentence.

Tanaka-san (resident)

そうなの。何時の バスかしら。

That's right. I wonder what time the bus is.

Why: かしら is a soft 'I wonder', 女性語. She is asking for a fact you cannot give her — so do not answer the fact. Answer the worry underneath it: she wants to know she is not stranded and not forgotten.

Hana (caregiver)

ご心配ですね。つらいですね。

You're worried, aren't you. That must be hard.

Why: Name the feeling before you do anything else (つらいですね, Ep 15). Two short sentences — with dementia, long explanations are noise. Say one idea, then stop and let her hear it.

Hana (caregiver)

お茶を 飲んでから、一緒に 考えませんか。

Shall we have some tea first, and think about it together?

Why: This is redirection, and notice what it does NOT do: it never says no. 〜てから = 'after doing 〜', so going home is not refused, only placed after the tea. 一緒に makes it something you do with her, not to her (Ep 9). Very often the coat comes off during the tea and the subject changes on its own.

Tanaka-san (resident)

じゃあ、少し いただくわ。

Well then, I'll have a little.

Why: いただく is the humble 'receive / have', and ～わ is again 女性語(じょせいご). The redirection landed. Do not now announce that she has forgotten about going home — just pour the tea.

Hana (caregiver)

ありがとうございます。ゆっくりで 大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)ですよ。無理(むり)には しませんよ。

Thank you. Take your time — that's fine. I won't push you.

Why: Hurry is what turns confusion into fear. ゆっくりで 大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)ですよ removes the clock, and 無理(むり)には しませんよ (Ep 14) tells her she keeps the right to say no. Both are short enough to be understood on a bad afternoon.

Tanaka-san (resident)

ねえ、さっきの こと、もう 一度(いちど) 聞(き)いても いい？

Say, can I ask you about that again?

Why: The same question, again. ～ても いい？ is 'may I?' — she is asking permission, which means some part of her knows she has asked before. That is exactly why your face matters more than your answer here.

Hana (caregiver)

はい、何度(なんど)でも どうぞ。ゆっくり お話(はな)ししますね。

Yes — as many times as you like. I'll go through it slowly.

Why: 何度(なんど)でも どうぞ = 'as many times as you like'. Say it warmly, the tenth time exactly as you said it the first — she cannot remember the question, but she will read your tone perfectly. お話(はな)しします is the humble 'I will explain'.

Hana (caregiver)

窓(まど)の そばに 座(すわ)りませんか。落(お)ち着(つ)くまで、そばに いますね。

Shall we sit by the window? I'll stay with you until you settle.

Why: A calm place and a familiar person do more than any sentence. ～まで = 'until', so you are promising to stay for as long as it takes, not for a minute. Sitting down beside her also puts your eyes at her level, which reads as 'I am not leaving'.

Hana (caregiver)

田中(たなか)さんの ペースで 大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)ですよ。娘(むすめ)さんには、私(わたし)から ご連絡(れんらく)いたしますね。

Your own pace is fine, Tanaka-san. I'll call your daughter myself.

Why: Close by handing the day back to her (～さんの ペースで, Ep 14) and by taking the one job she was worried about off her hands. ご連絡(れんらく)いたします is humble 'I will contact them' (Ep 16) — and it is a promise you must actually keep.

2 · Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES

1	帰る (かえ)	*kaeru*	to go home; return	
2	娘 (むすめ)	*musume*	daughter	
3	待つ (ま)	*matsu*	to wait	
4	いらっしゃる	*irassharu*	to be (respectful form of いる)	
5	心配 (しんぱい)	*shinpai*	worry; anxiety (recycled from Ep 16)	
6	つらい	*tsurai*	hard; painful to bear (recycled from Ep 15)	
7	お茶 (ちゃ)	*ocha*	tea	
8	考える (かんが)	*kangaeru*	to think about; consider	
9	大丈夫 (だいじょうぶ)	*daijoubu*	okay; all right (recycled from Ep 16)	
10	無理に (む り)	*murini*	forcibly; against someone's will	
11	もう 一度 (いちど)	*mouichido*	once more; again	
12	何度でも (なんど)	*nandodemo*	as many times as you like	
13	窓 (まど)	*mado*	window	
14	座る (すわ)	*suwaru*	to sit down	
15	落ち着く (お つ)	*ochitsuku*	to calm down; settle	
16	ペース		pace; one's own speed (recycled from Ep 16)	
17	連絡する (れんらく)	*renrakusuru*	to contact; get in touch (recycled from Ep 16)	

3 · Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
～んですね	Repeat her words back instead of correcting them

ご心配(しんぱい)ですね	Name the feeling before you answer anything
～てから、一緒(いっしょ)に ～ませんか	Redirect gently — never say no outright
何度(なんど)でも どうぞ	Answer the same question again, warmly
落(お)ち着(つ)くまで、そばに いますね	Stay beside her until she settles

4 · Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	What does Hana offer when Tanaka-san asks about the bus? A) 電話(でんわ) B) お茶(ちゃ) C) お風呂(ふろ) D) お薬(くすり)	
2	Tanaka-san asks the same question again. What does Hana say? A) さっき 言(い)いましたよ B) 何度(なんど)でも どうぞ C) あとで ですね D) 忘(わす)れましたか	
3	Repeat her words back: 'Your daughter is waiting for you, is she.'	
4	Name the feeling: 'You're worried, aren't you.'	
5	Promise to stay: 'I'll be beside you until you feel settled.'	

5 · Answer Key — こたえ

1. **お茶(ちゃ)を 飲(の)んでから、一緒(いっしょ)に 考(かんが)えませんか。**
2. **はい、何度(なんど)でも どうぞ。**
3. **娘(むすめ)さんが 待(ま)って いらっしゃるんですね。**
4. **ご心配(しんぱい)ですね。**
5. **落(お)ち着(つ)くまで、そばに いますね。**